position of the minorities may be weakened, resulting in an exodus to India. When the country was portioned in 1947, a sizeable strength of Hindus remained in the then East Pakistan in great contrast to the position in West Pakistan from where most of the Hindus moved to India at the time of Partition. Due to linguistic and ethnic affinities as also to better their economic prospects, Hindus in Bangladesh felt a pull towards India. Therefore, whenever conditions were propitious, they tried to emigrate to India. Some unauthorised movement from Bangladesh into India had always existed on the border; sometimes, even members of the majority community emigrated to Assam and Meghalaya in search of land. According to information available in the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) in 1975, about forty-seven lakh people moved to India between 1947 and February 1971 from the then East Pakistan. Due to the worsening economic situation in Bangladesh, the influx had increased since September 1974 and the Border Security Force (BSF) had intercepted about fifty thousand Bangladeshis from August 1974 to July 1975. After the coup, the number of illegal immigrants from Bangladesh declined due to tight security at the border. But intelligence sources revealed that the worst was yet to come. Attempts were being made by some elements in Bangladesh to terrorise the minority communities, which would lead to an even greater exodus of those communities. Even Bihari Muslims who were well settled in Bangladesh were attempting to return to India. An MHA note said:

After the assassination of Sheikh Mujib, a psychological warfare seems to have been started against the Hindus. There have been posters of communal nature and slogans against presence of Hindus in Bangladesh. Instances of harassment have been common. Fanatic Islamic organisations like Muslim League, Jamaat-e-Islami are at work in creating ill will against